

■ Alex

Barista / Part-time Student · Albuquerque, NM

INCOME: \$1,800/mo**MONTHLY EXPENSES:**

• Rent (shared apt)	\$600
• Food	\$300
• Transport (bus)	\$50
• Phone	\$45
• Subscriptions	\$30

■ **TWIST:** Student loan payment: \$200/mo

■ Jordan

Entry-Level Coder · Austin, TX

INCOME: \$4,200/mo**MONTHLY EXPENSES:**

• Rent (own studio)	\$1,400
• Food + Dining Out	\$600
• Car payment	\$320
• Phone	\$80
• Gym + subscriptions	\$90

■ **TWIST:** Student loans: \$450/mo. Loves eating out.

■ Morgan

Nurse (Night Shift) · Socorro, NM

INCOME: \$5,100/mo**MONTHLY EXPENSES:**

• Rent (2BR house)	\$950
• Food	\$350
• Car + gas	\$420
• Phone	\$60
• Childcare	\$800

■ **TWIST:** No student loans — went to community college!

■ Taylor

Social Media Manager · Los Angeles, CA

INCOME: \$3,000/mo**MONTHLY EXPENSES:**

• Rent (shared room!)	\$1,200
• Food	\$400
• Uber / transport	\$180
• Phone	\$75
• Fashion / misc	\$300

■ **TWIST:** Rent in LA is brutal. Side hustle earns +\$400/mo.

■ Casey

Mechanic · El Paso, TX

INCOME: \$3,600/mo**MONTHLY EXPENSES:**

• Rent (own place)	\$750
• Food + groceries	\$280
• Truck insurance+gas	\$220
• Phone	\$50
• Tools / equipment	\$150

■ **TWIST:** No college debt. Owns a used truck outright.

■ Riley

High School Teacher · Santa Fe, NM

INCOME: \$3,200/mo**MONTHLY EXPENSES:**

• Rent (1BR apartment)	\$900
• Food	\$300
• Car + gas	\$260
• Phone	\$55
• Student loans	\$380

■ **TWIST:** Qualifies for student loan forgiveness in 7 years.

■ Sam

Freelance Graphic Designer · Remote / anywhere

INCOME: \$2,400/mo avg

MONTHLY EXPENSES:

• Rent (parents' house)	\$0
• Food	\$250
• Software / Adobe	\$120
• Phone + internet	\$90
• Self-employment tax	\$480

■ **TWIST:** *Income varies! Some months \$1,800, some \$4,000.*

■■ Drew

Army Veteran / GI Bill Student · Las Cruces, NM

INCOME: \$2,000/mo (housing allowance)

MONTHLY EXPENSES:

• Rent (off-campus)	\$700
• Food	\$320
• Car + insurance	\$310
• Phone	\$45
• Books / supplies	\$80

■ **TWIST:** *Tuition is FREE via GI Bill. No student loans ever.*

■ The Trendsetter

Always first to have the new thing

INCOME: \$2,800/mo

PRESSURE: HIGH

YOUR PEER GROUP:

Your whole friend group upgrades every time Apple drops something.

■ **WEAKNESS:** FOMO — Fear of Missing Out

★ **STRENGTH:** Great taste & social connections

SAVINGS TRACKER (circle after each round):

Start

Yr 1

Yr 2

Yr 3

Yr 4

Yr 5

Age 30

■ The Athlete

Gear, gear, and more gear

INCOME: \$3,200/mo

PRESSURE: MEDIUM

YOUR PEER GROUP:

Your teammates always have the newest cleats, jerseys, and supplements.

■ **WEAKNESS:** Gear obsession — equipment > savings

★ **STRENGTH:** Discipline & goal-setting mindset

SAVINGS TRACKER (circle after each round):

Start

Yr 1

Yr 2

Yr 3

Yr 4

Yr 5

Age 30

■ The Social Butterfly

Every event, every outing, every dinner

INCOME: \$2,600/mo

PRESSURE: VERY HIGH

YOUR PEER GROUP:

Friends plan expensive dinners, trips, and concerts constantly.

■ **WEAKNESS:** Can't say no — social spending drains savings fast

★ **STRENGTH:** Strong network & people skills

SAVINGS TRACKER (circle after each round):

Start

Yr 1

Yr 2

Yr 3

Yr 4

Yr 5

Age 30

■ The Car Person

Ride matters more than anything

INCOME: \$3,400/mo

PRESSURE: MEDIUM

YOUR PEER GROUP:

Friends judge you by what you drive. Upgrades happen often.

■ **WEAKNESS:** Depreciating assets — cars lose value fast

★ **STRENGTH:** Mechanical skills, can do own repairs

SAVINGS TRACKER (circle after each round):

Start

Yr 1

Yr 2

Yr 3

Yr 4

Yr 5

Age 30

■ The Gamer

Latest console, best PC, all the DLC

INCOME: \$2,400/mo

PRESSURE: HIGH

YOUR PEER GROUP:

Online squad always has the newest titles and hardware.

■ **WEAKNESS:** Microtransactions & upgrade cycle never ends

★ **STRENGTH:** Tech-savvy, potential streaming income

SAVINGS TRACKER (circle after each round):

Start

Yr 1

Yr 2

Yr 3

Yr 4

Yr 5

Age 30

■ The Foodie

Only the best restaurants & experiences

INCOME: \$3,000/mo

PRESSURE: MEDIUM

YOUR PEER GROUP:

Friend group always wants the hottest new restaurant in town.

■ **WEAKNESS:** Experiences feel necessary, not optional

★ **STRENGTH:** Culinary skills — can cook gourmet at home

SAVINGS TRACKER (circle after each round):

Start

Yr 1

Yr 2

Yr 3

Yr 4

Yr 5

Age 30

■ **The Minimalist**

Less stuff, more freedom

INCOME: \$2,900/mo

PRESSURE: LOW

YOUR PEER GROUP:

Doesn't care much what others think. Buys only what's needed.

■ **WEAKNESS:** Can come across as antisocial sometimes

★ **STRENGTH:** Naturally saves money — highest starting savings!

SAVINGS TRACKER (circle after each round):

Start

Yr 1

Yr 2

Yr 3

Yr 4

Yr 5

Age 30

Company A

Technology

WHAT DO THEY DO?

A tech company that makes the world's most popular smartphones and laptops. Sells premium products at premium prices. Over 1 billion active devices

■ **HINT:** *Think: everyone you know has one of their products.*

TEAM DECISION:

INVEST ✓

Instructor: reveal answer after teams pick

Company B

Automotive / EV

WHAT DO THEY DO?

An electric car company run by a controversial billionaire. Burns through cash but dominates the EV market. Stock is extremely volatile.

■ **HINT:** *Love it or hate it — everyone has an opinion on this CEO.*

TEAM DECISION:

INVEST ✓

Instructor: reveal answer after teams pick

Company C

Food & Beverage

WHAT DO THEY DO?

A fast food chain with over 40,000 locations worldwide. Boring business. Same burgers since 1955. Extremely consistent profits.

■ **HINT:** *You've eaten here. Probably more than once this week.*

TEAM DECISION:

INVEST ✓

Instructor: reveal answer after teams pick

Company D

Social Media

WHAT DO THEY DO?

A social media company billions of people use daily but many say they hate. Advertising revenue is its entire business model.

■ **HINT:** *Your parents are definitely on this platform.*

TEAM DECISION:

INVEST ✓

Instructor: reveal answer after teams pick

Company E

E-Commerce / Cloud

WHAT DO THEY DO?

Sells everything from groceries to cloud computing. Started as an online bookstore in a garage. Now one of the most valuable companies on

■ **HINT:** *You've probably gotten a package from them this week.*

TEAM DECISION:

INVEST ✓

Instructor: reveal answer after teams pick

Company F

Entertainment

WHAT DO THEY DO?

A video streaming company that disrupted Hollywood. Had explosive growth during COVID but lost subscribers afterward. Big content spending.

■ **HINT:** *You've asked someone for their password for this.*

TEAM DECISION:

INVEST ✓

Instructor: reveal answer after teams pick

Company G

Semiconductors / AI

WHAT DO THEY DO?

Makes the chips that power AI. Every major tech company is their customer. Became the most valuable company in the world in 2024.

■ **HINT:** *The company that everyone in AI talks about right now.*

TEAM DECISION:

INVEST ✓

Instructor: reveal answer after teams pick

Company H

Retail

WHAT DO THEY DO?

A retail chain with giant stores selling everything at low prices. Biggest private employer in the USA. Competes hard on price.

■ **HINT:** *You can buy a TV, groceries, and a fishing rod in one trip.*

TEAM DECISION:

INVEST ✓

Instructor: reveal answer after teams pick

Company I

Financial Services

WHAT DO THEY DO?

A payment network that processes trillions of dollars of transactions every year. Doesn't make loans — just moves money between banks.

■ **HINT:** *Their logo is on almost every credit and debit card.*

TEAM DECISION:

INVEST ✓

Instructor: reveal answer after teams pick

Company J

Apparel / Footwear

WHAT DO THEY DO?

Makes athletic shoes and apparel. Relies on celebrity endorsements and brand loyalty. Faces rising competition from cheaper Asian brands.

■ **HINT:** *Just do it.*

TEAM DECISION:

INVEST ✓

Instructor: reveal answer after teams pick

Company A

Technology

WHAT DO THEY DO?

A tech company that makes the world's most popular smartphones and laptops. Sells premium products at premium prices. Over 1 billion active devices

■ **HINT:** Think: everyone you know has one of their products.

TEAM DECISION:

ANSWER: Apple (AAPL)

5yr: +312%

Company B

Automotive / EV

WHAT DO THEY DO?

An electric car company run by a controversial billionaire. Burns through cash but dominates the EV market. Stock is extremely volatile.

■ **HINT:** Love it or hate it — everyone has an opinion on this CEO.

TEAM DECISION:

ANSWER: Tesla (TSLA)

5yr: +621%

Company C

Food & Beverage

WHAT DO THEY DO?

A fast food chain with over 40,000 locations worldwide. Boring business. Same burgers since 1955. Extremely consistent profits.

■ **HINT:** You've eaten here. Probably more than once this week.

TEAM DECISION:

ANSWER: McDonald's (MCD)

5yr: +87%

Company D

Social Media

WHAT DO THEY DO?

A social media company billions of people use daily but many say they hate. Advertising revenue is its entire business model.

■ **HINT:** Your parents are definitely on this platform.

TEAM DECISION:

ANSWER: Meta / Facebook (META)

5yr: +143%

Company E

E-Commerce / Cloud

WHAT DO THEY DO?

Sells everything from groceries to cloud computing. Started as an online bookstore in a garage. Now one of the most valuable companies on

■ **HINT:** You've probably gotten a package from them this week.

TEAM DECISION:

ANSWER: Amazon (AMZN)

5yr: +98%

Company F

Entertainment

WHAT DO THEY DO?

A video streaming company that disrupted Hollywood. Had explosive growth during COVID but lost subscribers afterward. Big content spending.

■ **HINT:** You've asked someone for their password for this.

TEAM DECISION:

ANSWER: Netflix (NFLX)

5yr: +43%

Company G

Semiconductors / AI

WHAT DO THEY DO?

Makes the chips that power AI. Every major tech company is their customer. Became the most valuable company in the world in 2024.

■ **HINT:** *The company that everyone in AI talks about right now.*

TEAM DECISION:

ANSWER: NVIDIA (NVDA)

5yr: +1,840%

Company H

Retail

WHAT DO THEY DO?

A retail chain with giant stores selling everything at low prices. Biggest private employer in the USA. Competes hard on price.

■ **HINT:** *You can buy a TV, groceries, and a fishing rod in one trip.*

TEAM DECISION:

ANSWER: Walmart (WMT)

5yr: +116%

Company I

Financial Services

WHAT DO THEY DO?

A payment network that processes trillions of dollars of transactions every year. Doesn't make loans — just moves money between banks.

■ **HINT:** *Their logo is on almost every credit and debit card.*

TEAM DECISION:

ANSWER: Visa (V)

5yr: +72%

Company J

Apparel / Footwear

WHAT DO THEY DO?

Makes athletic shoes and apparel. Relies on celebrity endorsements and brand loyalty. Faces rising competition from cheaper Asian brands.

■ **HINT:** *Just do it.*

TEAM DECISION:

ANSWER: Nike (NKE)

5yr: +14%

■ Credit Card

DEBT CARD

BALANCE: **\$2,400**

Interest Rate: **24.99% APR**

Minimum Payment: **\$48/mo**

Highest interest rate. Dangerous if ignored.

Interest rate: 24.99% (bar = relative cost of this debt)

■ Medical Bill

DEBT CARD

BALANCE: **\$800**

Interest Rate: **0% APR**

Minimum Payment: **\$25/mo**

No interest! Smallest balance. Easy quick win.

Interest rate: 0% (bar = relative cost of this debt)

■ Car Loan

DEBT CARD

BALANCE: **\$8,500**

Interest Rate: **7.9% APR**

Minimum Payment: **\$210/mo**

Secured debt — miss payments and they repossess.

Interest rate: 7.9% (bar = relative cost of this debt)

■ Student Loan

DEBT CARD

BALANCE: **\$18,000**

Interest Rate: **5.5% APR**

Minimum Payment: **\$190/mo**

Largest balance. Lower rate but takes the longest.

Interest rate: 5.5% (bar = relative cost of this debt)

■ AVALANCHE METHOD

Pay highest interest rate first

1. Make minimum payments on ALL debts every month.
2. Put ALL extra money toward the HIGHEST interest debt.
3. When that debt is gone, attack the next highest rate.
4. Repeat until debt-free.

✓ **RESULT:** Saves the most money in total interest paid.

★ **FEEL:** Mathematically optimal — but can feel slow at first.

PAYOFF ORDER:

Credit Card (24.99%) → Car Loan (7.9%) →

Student Loan (5.5%) → Medical (\$0%)

❄️ ■ SNOWBALL METHOD

Pay smallest balance first

1. Make minimum payments on ALL debts every month.
2. Put ALL extra money toward the SMALLEST balance debt.
3. When that debt is gone, roll that payment to the next.
4. Repeat — your payment 'snowballs' bigger each time.

✓ **RESULT:** Pays off individual debts faster — boosts motivation.

★ **FEEL:** Psychologically satisfying — quick early wins feel great!

PAYOFF ORDER:

Medical (\$800) → Credit Card (\$2,400) → Car (\$8,500) →

Student (\$18,000)